



KAFKA

INTERVIEW

QUESTIONS

(4-6 YOE)

JAVA

DEVELOPER



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Kafka Fundamentals

- What is Apache Kafka?
- Why is Kafka called a distributed event streaming platform?
- What are the core components of Kafka?
- What is a Kafka Topic?
- What is a Kafka Partition?
- What is an Offset?
- What is a Kafka Broker?
- What is a Kafka Cluster?
- What is a Producer?
- What is a Consumer?
- What is a Consumer Group?
- How does Kafka differ from traditional message queues?
- What are the advantages of Kafka?
- What are common Kafka use cases?
- Why is Kafka highly scalable?

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Topics, Partitions & Ordering

- Why are topics divided into partitions?
- How does partitioning improve scalability?
- How does Kafka decide which partition receives a message?
- What is key-based partitioning?
- What is round-robin partitioning?
- What happens when messages have the same key?
- How is ordering maintained in Kafka?
- Is ordering guaranteed across partitions?
- What happens when you increase partition count?
- Can increasing partitions affect message ordering?
- How do you choose the ideal number of partitions?
- What is partition skew?
- How do you handle uneven partition distribution?

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Kafka Producer

- How does a Kafka Producer work?
- What is a ProducerRecord?
- What is KafkaTemplate in Spring Kafka?
- Is send() synchronous or asynchronous?
- How do callbacks work in Kafka producers?
- What is the purpose of retries?
- What happens when retries are exhausted?
- What does acks=0 mean?
- What does acks=1 mean?
- What does acks=all mean?
- Which acknowledgment setting would you use in production?
- What is linger.ms?
- What is batch.size?
- What is compression.type?
- How can producer throughput be improved?
- What is producer buffering?
- What is max.in.flight.requests.per.connection?
- What is producer idempotency?
- How do you enable idempotent producers?
- What problems does idempotency solve?

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Kafka Consumer

- How does a Kafka Consumer read messages?
- What is the role of the poll() method?
- How does a Consumer Group work?
- How are partitions assigned among consumers?
- Can multiple consumer groups consume the same message?
- What is Consumer Lag?
- How do you monitor consumer lag?
- What is max.poll.records?
- What is max.poll.interval.ms?
- What is session.timeout.ms?
- What is heartbeat.interval.ms?
- What is auto.offset.reset?
- Difference between earliest and latest offset reset policies?
- What happens if a consumer crashes?
- What is a rebalance?
- What triggers a rebalance?
- How can rebalances be minimized?

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Offset Management

- What is an offset?
- How are offsets stored?
- What is offset commit?
- What is auto offset commit?
- What is manual offset commit?
- Difference between commitSync() and commitAsync()?
- What happens if offset commit fails?
- What is At-Most-Once delivery?
- What is At-Least-Once delivery?
- What is Exactly-Once delivery?
- Which delivery guarantee is most commonly used?
- How do you avoid duplicate processing?
- How do you reprocess old messages?

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Replication & Fault Tolerance

- What is replication in Kafka?
- Why is replication important?
- What is a replication factor?
- What is a leader partition?
- What is a follower partition?
- What is ISR (In-Sync Replicas)?
- What happens when a broker fails?
- What happens if the leader broker goes down?
- How is a new leader elected?
- What is unclean leader election?
- Why is unclean leader election risky?
- What is broker failover?

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Kafka Delivery Guarantees

- Explain At-Most-Once processing.
- Explain At-Least-Once processing.
- Explain Exactly-Once processing.
- How does Kafka achieve Exactly-Once semantics?
- What are transactions in Kafka?
- What is transactional.id?
- How do transactions help avoid duplicates?
- What are the limitations of Exactly-Once processing?

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Spring Boot + Kafka

- How do you configure Kafka in Spring Boot?
- What is @KafkaListener?
- How does KafkaTemplate work?
- How do you consume messages from multiple topics?
- How do you configure retry mechanisms?
- How do you implement Dead Letter Topics (DLT)?
- How do you handle deserialization exceptions?
- How do you pause and resume consumers?
- How do you implement manual acknowledgment?
- How do you configure concurrency in Kafka listeners?

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